

STATUS: APPROVED

Purpose

This section defines the Search Engine Optimization (SEO) architecture for the CLA website.

The goal is to make the website discoverable, well-structured, and easy for search engines to understand while providing an excellent experience for visitors.

SEO Philosophy

SEO should always support people before search engines.

Every page should be written primarily for visitors while following modern SEO best practices.

Page Metadata

Every page should include:

- * Unique page title
- * Meta description
- * Canonical URL
- * Open Graph metadata
- * Twitter/X metadata (where applicable)

Metadata should accurately describe the page content.

URL Structure

URLs should be:

- * Short
- * Descriptive
- * Human-readable
- * Consistent

CamelCase should not be used in URLs.

Examples:

- * /visit

- * /ministries
 - * /kids
 - * /events
 - * /sermons
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Heading Structure

Every page should maintain a logical heading hierarchy.

- * One H1 per page
- * Proper H2 hierarchy
- * H3 and lower only when needed

Headings should describe content rather than exist only for SEO.

Structured Data

Structured data should be implemented whenever appropriate.

Examples include:

- * Church
- * Organization
- * Events
- * Articles
- * Videos
- * Breadcrumbs

Structured data should follow current Schema.org standards.

Images

Every meaningful image should include descriptive alt text.

Image filenames should remain descriptive and organized.

Internal Linking

Pages should naturally link to related content.

Internal links should improve navigation and help visitors discover additional resources.

Sitemap

The website should maintain an updated XML sitemap.

New public pages should automatically become part of the sitemap whenever practical.

Robots

A robots.txt file should remain part of the project.

It should clearly define which content may or may not be indexed.

Performance & SEO

Performance directly supports SEO.

The website should prioritize:

- * Fast loading
- * Mobile usability
- * Accessibility
- * Clean HTML
- * Optimized assets

Future Reviews

SEO should be reviewed during every six-month architecture review.

New search engine best practices may be adopted when they improve discoverability without compromising user experience.

Guiding Principle

Great SEO begins with creating valuable content and an excellent experience for people.

End of Section 8